

Official Curtis Riggleman

CLOSING 101

BOOK FIVE

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Curtis Riggleman



Closing 101

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www.officialcurtisriggleman.com

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Introduction

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN IN THIS BOOK:

I will show you my techniques and frame work to closing deals. I will give you some word tracks that work well, but the work tracks are not the answer- they are quick solutions to push through a stall or minor objection. The root to closing deals and holding gross (profit) is tapping into the emotion. We need to focus on the value, the why, the pain, the optimal outcome, and what changes or stays the same if we do nothing?

Once you learn the techniques in this book, you will notice that you are getting to yes with your customers more often, and that you will be able to hold more gross profit in the vehicles.

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The Art Of The Close

80% of closing is done in the discovery process (investigation). Asking the right questions and listening to their hot points is key; you will need to use that information later.

We want to focus on their hot points. This is the key to maximizing gross.

Delivery plays a huge role in closing.

Are you confident? Are you smooth (fluid)? Do you believe what you are saying? Do you think it's going to work? You put off a vibe one way or the other. When you're not confident in your pitch, your customer is going to feel that vibe. They won't tell you and they won't know why. They can't say yes. Something just won't feel right to them. The saying "fake it 'til you make it)" applies here. Deliver the same way every sale. As each transaction starts to move forward, so will your confidence. Once you have put in enough reps, and you are extremely confident when you deliver the offer, you'll start getting the response you want. The key to success here is in your vibe, the unspoken aura around you. **Use your big smile energy!**

It's not what you say, but how you say it.

Many times, after I've closed a deal after the salesman and/or closer tried and failed, the sales rep comes to me after the close. He'll say, "I told him the same thing and he said no, you said it and he said yes." That's because when they said it they had doubt about their process. I may have used that close a few hundred times, so my confidence was a lot stronger in the delivery.

This is why you have to put in the reps, practicing role playing, practicing your lines when you are not with a customer. If the only time you practice is on customer, you will be learning a very expensive lesson!

Another important key to closing is knowing when to talk and when to wait.

Get comfortable with silence. A lot of sales people can't handle silence and they feel like they have to talk. This nervous energy raises red flags to the customer. If this is a good product and deal, they will unconsciously wonder why you keep selling it. You can actually ruin your car deal by talking too much. You can turn a buyer back into a shopper. You have to become comfortable waiting for them to talk. A lot of salespeople will start overcoming what they think the customer is going to say before they have even said it. Never speak for the customer and never assume you know what the customer is going to say before he says it. Deliver the offer with confidence and calmly wait for the customer to respond.

One of the most powerful words in closing is "Why?"

Asking questions will lead to the close. Most sales people will just continue talking and trying to close with pressure, when sometimes you can sit back and just say, "Why is that important?" If you sit back and listen, the close will expose itself.

EXAMPLE:

Customer: I want the 4x4.

The problem here is that the 4x4 is \$3500 more and raises the payment \$75 per month.

The customer doesn't want to pay it. Instead of negotiating that \$75, and grinding down to a mini, I would sit back and ask:

Sales: **Why** is the 4x4 so important?

Customer: We take a trip once a year to the snow for a family trip and it requires 4x4.

Sales: How many times besides that scenario have you used the 4x4?

Customer: That's it, but I have to have it for that trip.

Sales: Can I show you a way to have your 4x4 for your trip and save you thousands of dollars? Would you be open to listening?

Customer: Yes

Sales: Here is what I see. The extra payment is \$75 per month x 72 months, which is \$5400. Now add gas miles. Decrease 3 miles per gallon to drive the 4x4 the other 364 days of the year when you are not using it. Add to that slightly higher insurance and maintenance cost. You can rent a 4x4 the day you need it for around \$100 once a year, instead of paying \$75 more per month just to use it once per year. That would save you about \$5400. I have the same truck as this one in 2wd. That would fit perfect in your budget. Can I pull that up for you to take a look at it?

Customer: I'll look at it.

KEY TAKEAWAY:

Instead of getting stuck on something, first sit back and simply ask, “Why?” See what unfolds. This is just one example but the word “why” is very important when closing deals. **Don't miss the clues to your close.**

The Power Of Persuasion

My definition of persuasion is this: Getting the outcome you desire while the person you are persuading believes that it is his or her idea.

I've learned how to persuade customers by framing the right questions. We will be looking at some effective ways to frame questions.

TECHNIQUE: QUESTION WITH OPTIONS

One of the most effective ways to influence the customer to give the answer you want is by asking option questions and ending with the option you want them to take. Raise your tone while asking the option that you want them to agree to. This adds a subtle emphasis that helps the customer to remember this option first.

EXAMPLE:

Customer: I don't want to do anything until I know what my car is worth.

Don't make the mistake of trying to overcome this objection or showing a trade value first with no purchase vehicle attached to it. You will not have any emotion attached to it, and therefore you are very likely to lose the sale. No emotion, no sale. Instead, try this:

Sales: Is this trade value your only concern, or is the deal you get on your new car important as well? **or both?**

By framing it this way, and using a slight increase in tone when I say "or both?", they are likely to respond "both." Then I can follow up with reconnecting them to the purpose of choosing a car so that I can get them emotionally involved.

Sales: Great! I'll have my used car manager start getting bids on your trade while we pick out your next vehicle, that way I can get you the best numbers on both so that you can make the best decision.

Now the customer feels like this was his idea and that he is in control. This feels like no pressure, and we have already agreed to the next few steps to the sale. Now I can start building rapport and not focus so much on the unit or the deal. I want to always frame everything to the customer's benefit. If the customer thinks that you are trying to get something for your own benefit, or in the dealer's best interest, they will be defensive and refuse to proceed. Everything you offer must feel like it's in their best interest. Always say "you" and "your", never use "me" or "my" when trying to persuade a customer. Practice framing everything to your customer's best interest so that it becomes second nature.

Keep Yourself In The Middle

As a closer, think of yourself as a mediator.

Your job is to get two parties to agree; the customer and the dealer. As long as the customer believes that you are helping them move toward their goals, they will continue to listen and help move the process forward. As soon as they think that it is “you against them”, the walls go up, and the sale is more difficult, or more likely, lost altogether.

EXAMPLES:

YES:

Closer: Can we try this? Would you back me up if we can get this done for you?

NO:

Closer: That's not going to work. I'm going to need more money down to get you to that payment.

YES:

Closer: You and I have the same goal. You came to buy a car and I came to sell one. Let's work together so that we both can win.

If your customer gets defensive and thinks that you are not working toward their best interest, they will say things like:

Customer: That's okay, we don't have to buy anything today. We are not in a rush.

OR:

Customer: We really just wanted to get an idea what it would take.

Let them know that you are the final decision maker, but that you are going to work hard to accomplish what they want to get done.

When your customers believe that you are working for them, they are likely to follow their natural human instinct to want to "reward" someone for hard work. They will even want to buy just to help you make the sale. This is a natural human instinct to be obliging and to get along.

Value Over Price

Before we get into techniques and examples, know that there are only two ways to close a car deal: value or price. If the value exceeds the price, it's a good deal. When the price is lower than the value, it's a good deal. If you just want to turn a unit and don't care about making money, just lower the price until you have gone below what the customer feels the value is.

If you want to hold gross, you must raise the value over the price. When you raise the value of the product, yourself, and your dealership, it feels like a good deal in relation to value to the customer. The customer leaves happy because they got a good deal, and feel value in what they bought. They seem to be the happiest customers. The customers who haggle on price alone always seem to leave upset and unhappy because they only bought based on price, they don't feel the value in their purchase. **There is a difference between a good deal and a cheap deal.**

Raise the value of the product, yourself, and your dealership. And help your customer to feel good about paying more for value.

EXAMPLE:

Customer: I saw this vehicle for cheaper somewhere else.

Instead of arguing, or making them explain, agree with them, then build value.

Sales: I agree, Mr. Customer, I've seen some cheaper myself. Can I tell you why more people end up buying here anyway?

Customer: Ok, why?

Sales: Every one of our used cars goes through our shop. Whatever needs fixed, replaced, or repaired is done before it comes to the lot. Here's the crazy part: almost half the cars we put in don't make it past our inspections. Those that don't go to the auction and often end up on other lots for cheaper, where they don't require the inspections we do. Our goal is to make sure you get what you pay for, and never less than you expected. I'll go get the keys.

I just raised value over price, and gave the customer a reason to feel good about paying more.

KEY TAKEAWAY:

There is a difference between a good deal and a cheap deal. Provide value, the customer doesn't know what value is until you tell him!

Emotion Creates Motion

Buying nice stuff is an emotional decision.

This is true whether your customer wants to admit it or not, hence the term “retail therapy”.

Our job is to find that emotion in the customer. We want to tap into that emotion during the steps of the sale.

When a customer wants a specific feature in a new vehicle that they don't currently have, there is a reason why. And typically, that reason is an emotion tied to a fantasy of what they could do with their new car.

EXAMPLE #1:

Customer: I really want a moonroof on this one.

Don't make the mistake of ignoring this information or trying to move past it. **Ask why!**

Sales: Mr. Customer, it's pretty hot here, you probably won't use it a lot here. Where do you plan on using it?

Customer: It'll be for my wife and I when we go to the coast.

Sales: Ahh, that makes sense. How often do you guys go to the coast?

Customer: Usually once a month.

Sales: That's perfect. Pull the top back with that nice cool coast air! That will be nice! When is your next trip?

Customer: We are hoping to go this weekend.

Now we have an emotional tie to the vehicle. When it comes time to close the deal, it is not the moonroof that will help you, it's the visual of being at the coast with that cool air coming through the top that fulfills their emotional desire.

EXAMPLE 2:

Customer: We have to have a tow package on this one.

Sales: No problem. Can I ask **why** the tow package is important?

Customer: We just picked up a little travel trailer and we want to take the grandkids camping.

Sales: Ahh, that's awesome!

Now we have an emotional tie to the vehicle.

When it comes time to close the deal, if we need a bump, we can tap into the visual of a weekend at the mountains with the grands.

Sales: Mr. Customer, I want you to picture this: You are in the mountains with your camper, grandkids running around, laughing, having fun. You and your wife are relaxing in the chairs, with a fire going, and a cold drink. Do you think that extra \$40 a month to buy this truck is going to be on your mind? Let's get one step closer to making this weekend trip a reality. I just need you to approve this and I will put this truck in Detail.

Use emotion to hold the gross. Don't talk about "skipping Starbucks" or "skipping eating out" as a way to afford their payment. This has a negative feel, a sacrifice, to the customer. It doesn't work, even as a joke. Instead, use the visual they gave you of using the vehicle in their "fantasy". This is much more powerful of a motivator than saving a few dollars. People will go over budget if you tap into emotion, but NOT if you use logic. **Emotion creates motion.**

The Set Up

Now for the good stuff. Your set up starts at “hello.”

Every customer has a predetermined thought of us before they arrive. If I start off by sounding like the last salesman they dealt with, I’m going to trigger a negative emotion in the customer. That is why I have developed the **Power Meet & Greet** technique.

The Power Meet & Greet is simple:

“Thank you for giving me the opportunity to work with you. My goal today is to provide you with world class service. Before we get started, can I get you some water or coffee?”

The Power Meet & Greet is a pattern interrupt. The customer expected me to say “Can I help you?” They planned to say, “No, thank you, we are just looking.” When you use the Power Meet & Greet, it is very hard to stick to their original plan of avoiding interacting with you when you are friendly and offering world class service up front.

EXAMPLE #1:

Sales: (Directly after the Power Meet & Greet)
Do you have something you want to take a look at, or do you just want to see what we have available?

Customer: (Shows me a stock number on their phone) Do you have this in stock?

Sales: Right this way!

Now we start moving. I don't want to walk fast. I need about 3-5 minutes to talk to the customer to investigate. I have my big smile energy and go straight into the investigation questions. I'm going to find out who it's for, wants, needs, budget. At the same time, I'm going to remove all their “ways out” later (backdoors) and I'm going to find value, leverage, and any emotional tie downs.

Sales: So who is the lucky one getting a new car? (This question eliminates the possible back door objection of the person not being present.)

Customer: It's going to be for me.

Sales: Congratulations! How long have you been thinking of getting a new car (or truck)?

Customer: About a month or so.

Note: I just removed the backdoor objection “We just started looking” later in the close.

Sales: OK! Well, you picked a good one. What is it about this one that jumped out to you?

Customer: (Starts telling you stories about what they like on the vehicle. Listen to the value. When you have the opportunity, ask why?)

As the customer is talking and giving value, you might say something like:

Sales: You said that you need this truck to be 4X4. Do you have 4X4 now?

Customer: No, but I want it on this one.

Sales: Ok. Got it. **Why** is the 4X4 so important this time?

Customer: Well, our kids are getting older now, so we want to start taking them to the mountains and the snow this year. Our youngest has never been to the snow.

Now you have an emotional tie to the vehicle.

At this point, I will recap what I heard, showing the customer that I have listened to their wants and needs. This sets me up for the budget question.

Sales: Awesome. So if I understand you right, we need 4 doors so the kids can sit in the back. You definitely want the V6 for the power, and it must be 4X4 so that you and the family can start taking those getaway trips to the snow. Does this sound about right?

Customer: Yes, that's it.

Sales: Great. And if this all works out, what monthly budget have you set aside for this?

Customer: 600ish

If you are feeling confident that your close is set up properly, go get the keys. As I'm showing the car or truck, I may ask:

Sales: Now, for any reason, if this one doesn't fit in your budget, would you be considering anything else?

This sounds like you are trying to switch them into another vehicle, so the customer almost always answers "No, this is the only one I want. Now we removed the potential objection "I need to look at another car."

In this relatively short amount of time, I have discovered who my buyer is, how long they have been shopping, what they see value in, an emotional tie in, and I have removed looking at another vehicle. I have all the ammo I need to close this deal later.

KEY TAKEAWAY: 80% of successful closing is asking the right questions up front.

The Write Up

Never ask about the down payment outside.

Assume no money down, because if they do have money down, it only makes the deal better.

When you ask for the down payment, inside, you create a resistance in the customer that forms the perfect combination of doubt and hope. The customer has to doubt the offer will work, but hope that it does. They need to feel like they have to work for the deal, they need to feel that they won.

A good write up is the perfect combination of doubt and hope. Too much of one or the other will hurt your deal. As I start my write up, I'll start with a credit question because it sets up my next step. From now on, everything is a set up for the next step.

EXAMPLE:

Sales: Now, Mr. Customer, tell me about your credit. Would you say it's A credit which means perfect, or B credit which is really good, C credit which is fair to average, or D which means "could use a little help?"

Customer: A credit.

Sales: Perfect! Congratulations on having great credit. That makes my job a lot easier. With A credit, we normally suggest at least 10% down so that you cover tax and license. Of course, you know the more you put down, the lower your payment would be. Do you want to work with the 10% or do you have something else in mind?

I want to make the impression that everyone with A credit puts 10% or better down. If the customer responds with wanting to put no money down, we have opened the door to discuss a bigger payment:

Sales: No problem. On something like this, with no money down, we would be looking at a payment of 700 to 800, depending on rate and term, things like that. Does that work for you?

Customer: I need the payment to be at 600 to 650.

Now you go back and work the down payment, but you need to frame everything to the customer's benefit.

Sales: Mr. Customer, so that we can help get this payment close to where **you are comfortable**, to what **you had in mind**, it may take that 10% down, maybe more. Can you cover the 10% to help get to **your budget**?

Customer: Well, I can do \$2000 down.

Now it's time to show them how their down payment affects their payment. We are now negotiating the variables of down payment, terms, and monthly payment.

Sales: Mr. Customer, your 2000 down should lower your payment approximately \$40 per month. That would put us in the \$660 to \$760 range. Would that work better for you?

Customer: If you can keep it to \$660, I can do that.

From this exchange, I now have two down payment commitments, and two payment commitments to work with. It is time to go for the full commitment, but you always need to position yourself in the middle. Write up your "I will buy now at" offer. You always want to talk and write at the same time. Never allow dead air.

Sales: Here is what I am going to tell my boss. (as I turn the paper toward the customer. Before he signs, I'll say:) Now keep in mind this is just an offer, it might not work. But I promise you, no one will work harder for you than me.

This is where the hope and doubt come into play. This is exactly where you want them. Sometimes the customers will even root for me, "Come on Curtis! You can do it!"

As I get up to walk to the sales office, I stop and plant my seed for the bump.

Sales: Mr. Customer, we are probably 60 to 80 dollars away from the payment you want, but wish me luck!

While I am away at the sales office, my customers are likely to be discussing how they will cover the extra 60 to 80 dollars for the payment. This works out great, because by the time I get back, they already have a new limit in mind.

KEY TAKEAWAY:

It's the set up that makes the close easy.



Notes:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins or other markings on the paper.

The Big Pencil

The big pencil is where all the tools, value, leverage, and emotion come into play. Instead of giving away price, we use what we have collected.

The first round (pencil) is designed to be big. We have our commitment from the customer, and the desk is ready to counter. This is your biggest bump, and this is where your money is made.

The big pencil is where your money is made.

This is where your customer gets uncomfortable and wants to exit. They will often try to use the backdoors that we removed earlier. Because we removed them once, we can use that information to refocus the customer back to the table.

EXAMPLE:

Sales: Great news, Mr. Customer. With your good credit, we have a couple of options for you. With just \$3500 down, if you want an extended 100k warranty, gap insurance, and life oil changes, you are looking at \$759 per month. If you are comfortable taking it as is without the extras, you are at just \$725.

Customer: Thank you Curtis. This gives us a good idea. Can we get a copy of that? We need to sleep on it, and think about it.

Don't panic and start offering lower payments or lower price! The panic vibe makes the customer feel that something is wrong. They will be defensive and continue to insist that they need to step away and think about it.

Stay calm. You set the tone! If you stay calm, you have the best chance to help the customer stay at the table instead of wanting to run.

Try this:

Sales: Mr. Customer, I hear you when you say you want to think about it, but earlier, when we were outside, I asked you how long you've been thinking about getting a new car. You said it's been a month. In fact, you went to another dealer and they didn't have what you wanted. This is the perfect vehicle. That being said, I don't think you need more time to think. I think there is something on this paper that doesn't work for you. Am I right?

We addressed this back door objection earlier in the process. This escape route is no good. It forces the customer to tell us what doesn't work on the paper, which allows us to move forward with the sale. Once they agree that the problem is on the paper, we start the process of negotiating until we have the second offer from the customer. For example:

Sales: Mr. Customer, what bothers you the most here, is it the down payment, the monthly payment, or both?

Customer: Both

Sales: Ok. No problem. Now they (the dealer, you keep your position as the middle) are asking for \$3500 down. Can you do that?

Customer: No

Sales: No problem. How close to it can you do?

Customer: \$2500 is my max.

Sales: Great. Every little bit helps. Removing \$1000 from the \$3500 down would increase the monthly payment an additional \$20, putting us at \$779 with warranty, or \$745 as is. Which way do you feel works best?

Customer: Neither.

Sales: No problem. Payment difference aside, do you see value in the warranty, oil change plan, and gap insurance?

Customer: Yes, but the payment is too high.

Sales: (With doubt in my tone) This probably won't work, but I'm willing to try. If we can get the warranty, oil changes, and gap insurance included in the non protected payment, would you back me up for that?

Maybe they say yes, maybe they say no. If it is “no”, I keep narrowing down until I get a “yes. But the main thing here, is that when they tried to use a back door escape route, I used the information gained earlier to bring their focus back to the table. I can control what is happening at the table versus trying to fix something that is not real. Once I moved past their attempted way out, I have my bump and the second offer to take back to the desk. At this point you should be really close to a deal. You are hopefully \$30-\$50 close to a full pop deal.

As you are walking back to the desk with the second offer in hand, offer a big smile, big excitement. You should now be saying things like “Who are you going to show the car off to first?” or “Where is the first place you are going in your new car?” This is the time to help them visualize the future with the car, to bring their emotion up. This gets them to accept ownership before asking for the last \$50/month to seal the deal.

Sales: (As I lay the pencil down before them) Look at this: just \$765 with warranty, oil changes, and gap insurance. This has everything you wanted. Just sign right here.

Assume the sale. Never walk back to the customer with doubt, or a defeated look on your face. Your customer will read that.

Now, let's say you did everything right, big energy, good delivery, and the customer says that he just can't do the payment.

Customer: Curtis, I'm sorry, I just can't do that payment. \$745 was my tops.

Sales: (This is where I'll use that leverage that we gleaned early on in the process- the emotional tie) Mr. Customer, I know it's \$25 more than you anticipated, but I want you to think about this: you are at the campground this weekend with the grand kids. Everyone is having fun. You and your wife are relaxing, enjoying just watching the kids play. Do you think that \$25 bucks is going to cross your mind? Those memories are priceless. Let's get this car in Detail and get this part behind you. First tank of gas is on us. Let me get your signature right here, and we will wrap this up.

Customer: Ok. Let's do it!

Anyone can continue sliding on payment or price until someone says “yes”. That's the route where you'll make no money. And your customer won't be happy either, because there is no value in that. People feel good about a purchase when the value is greater than the cost. Being an order taker, and just sliding on price or payment doesn't increase value. That is why the customers who pay the least are often the ones to leave unhappy.

No value, no reward.

Closer/Sales Manager Set Up

If your store uses closers, or the sales manager closes the deals, the closer needs to get his or her leverage as well.

The sales person should relay the information they collected outside to the manager before the manager goes out to close the deal.

As a manager, I like to do a quick meet and greet before talking about the deal. I'll go, sit down, and introduce myself. I'll ask a few questions.

Sales Manager: Welcome to ABC Motors. You ran into one of my best salesmen. I hope everything is going okay so far?

Customer: Oh yeah, everything is going great.

Sales Manager: Ok. Good, so what did you guys think of the test drive? (If no test drive was done, we stop here and push for a test drive. If the drive was good, then move forward.) What was it about this car (or truck) that made you decide to go with this one?

Let them talk. And listen.

Sales Manager: Ok great. Well, you picked a nice one. If you don't mind me asking, for my ad purposes, were we the best price or was it that we had the right car for you?

Customer: This is exactly what we wanted (OR this was the best price.)

Either answer gives you leverage. As a closer, you only have a couple of minutes to collect what you can. Now you can lay out the first pencil and get to work.

KEY TAKEAWAYS SO FAR:

- Good closing, with gross, is good fact finding up front.
- Good closing is good listening.
- Good closing is good set ups.
- Find the emotion by finding the right questions. You can even use negative emotion to your advantage.
- Find the pain point, or the ideal outcome,

Uncover The Problem

Most of us want to fix everything. We go into fix mode without uncovering the root problem.

In this chapter we will explore examples of stalls, backdoors, etc, and how to uncover the real problem instead of trying to fix the smoke-screen.

Be aware of the 3 P's: People, Product, or Price. This memory device has been out forever, and it still works today. Basically, you are just helping the customer uncover the truth. Which of these are the root of the customer's objection?

EXAMPLE #1:

Customer: I need to think about it.

Sales: Not a problem, Mr. Customer. I understand. Now when you say you need to think about it, is it myself and/or the store you need to think about? Is it the vehicle you need to think about? Or is it the money you need to think about?

Customer: (Almost always) It's the money.

Notice that I ended my statement with the option that I wanted them to repeat. When they say "the money", you are back in the game. You've brought it back to the paper, the one thing you have control of.

EXAMPLE#2:

Customer: Let me talk to my wife about it.

Sales: Not a problem, Mr. Customer. Since she is not here, I'm assuming that she has her own vehicle right?

Customer: Yes, she does.

Sales: Ok. So is it the vehicle you need to talk to her about, or is it more the money you need to talk to her about?

Customer: It's the money.

Sales: Got it. So if the money part was worked out, would she need to be here for any reason?

Customer: No, not if the money is right.

Sales: Perfect. So do you think she will object to the down payment, the monthly payment, or both?

Customer: Both.

Notice again that I ended my statement with the option that I wanted him to repeat. We are back in the game **and** we've established that the wife doesn't need to be here to make a decision.

Again, we are removing the stalls, or smoke-screens, to get to the root. If I went down the road of "where's the wife, can we show her?" we would never get to show her because it was never the real problem.

If you have done the proper work outside, you can be a bit more direct as well.

EXAMPLE#3:

Customer: I need to sleep on it.

Sales: I get it, Mr. Customer, but earlier you did tell me you have been looking for this truck for a month, and that this is the exact color you wanted and everything. My guess is you don't need more time to think or sleep on it. My guess is the problem is on this piece of paper. Am I right? (as I am nodding my head yes)

Notice again that I ended my statement with the option that I wanted him to repeat. The customer says yes, and we are back in the game.

KEY TAKEAWAY:

When the customer says “I need to (whatever)”, stop trying to fix the smoke screen, and start uncovering the truth, using the 3P’s, People, Product, or Price. Find the truth, the real reason, and use that to close. Like I said earlier, closing is not a set of magic words. It is asking the right questions and listening to your customers. They will tell you how to close them.



Notes:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are approximately 20 lines visible. The paper has a slightly aged or off-white appearance.

One Liners

What to do if you feel you are losing the customer's focus? This chapter will explore one liners to help you get back on track.

Ultimately, your value, leverage, and emotional ties are what is going to close the deal, but just in case you need that little extra help, let's get to those one liners.

1. **Compare Payments:** “Mr. Customer, you are paying \$600 now, and the new one is \$700. Would you agree that they are both high payments?” (Customer says yes) “Wouldn’t you rather get the vehicle you really want, a new car under warranty and problem free if you are going to make a high payment anyway?”
2. **Wouldn’t you rather:** “Wouldn’t you rather pay a little more and get exactly what you expect than get less than what you expected?”
3. **Cost Of Ownership Close:** “Mr. Customer, you are paying \$500/month now plus you are needing new tires soon, and probably brakes. That’s \$2000 if they don’t find any surprises. You take that \$2000 and divide it by 12 months, you are paying \$660/month anyway. You are just paying it on an old car vs. the new one.”
4. **Add To, Don’t Take Away:** “Mr. Customer, you buy a Starbucks once a day right? That is \$5 a day. If you felt like a second coffee later that day, would you check your budget or just go get it? (Customer says he would get it.) This new car is less than 1 Starbucks coffee per day. Just get it.”

5. **Sell Yourself:** “Mr. Customer, here’s my cell. If you have any questions or concerns with your new car or just need to schedule an oil change, call me first. I’m here for you after the sale. Let’s get your autograph right here, and we’ll wrap this up.”
6. **Waiting Never Helps:** “Mr. Customer, your trade will continue to depreciate, and new cars will continue to get more expensive. There’s no better time than now. Let’s put this shopping trip behind you.”
7. **Marry The Car, Date The Rate:** “Mr. Customer, rates going up are the best thing that’s happened. It’s exactly what brought prices down. When rates come down, prices will go back up. Buy smart. Take advantage of prices while they are down, then refinance when rates come down.”
8. **Per Pay Period Close:** “Look at it this way. It’s just \$10 per paycheck, not \$40 per month.”
9. **Close The Additional Payment:** “Mr. Customer, your brand new car is only \$150 a month from your current payment on your trade in.”

- 10. Close Themselves:** “Mr. Customer, you have a nice car now. I don’t see anything wrong with it. Why are you replacing it?”
- 11. Give It Back:** “Mr. Customer, I agree. I think if you are willing to answer phones, take time off work, meet with people for test drives, and go to their credit union to see if they get approved, you can get more for the trade. Would it be okay to take the trade out of the deal? It would be better for both of us.”
- 12. Where Did You Get That Trade Number??:** “Mr. Customer, if you don’t mind me asking, where did you get that trade number?” (Customer says that is what he sees them selling for) “Ahh. That makes sense. Unfortunately, we only see what they are asking, not what they actually sell for. If they are asking 20K, they will probably take 18. And the 18 needs to be profit, plus all the recon costs as well as smog and safety. Now you may be able to get that 18K, but you will have to take more time off work, take test drives with strangers, answer a million calls, then see if they are approved by their bank. To avoid all that trouble, what’s the lowest you are willing to take right now?”

- 13. Scale Of 1 To 10:** “Mr. Customer, on a scale of 1 to 10, with 10 being ready to drive it home, and 1 is not at all, where would you say you are at?” Whatever the answer is, your follow up question would be: “What would it take to get to a 10?” This is another old school word track, but it still works because you are uncovering the real problem.
- 14. Permission For Payment:** “Mr. Customer, if for any reason we can’t get to the payment you want, would it be okay to show what I can do and you let me know from there what you’d like to do?”
- 15. Permission For Trade:** “Mr. Customer, if for any reason we can’t get to the \$20,000 that you want for your trade in, would it be okay to show what I can do and you let me know from there what you’d like to do?”

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- Asking permission to a question that you know they will agree to makes them feel in control and comfortable moving forward.
- These are examples of moving the deal forward, but ultimately your value, leverage, and emotional ties are what closes the deal.

Negative Triggers

At the closing table, there are some negative trigger words you want to avoid. This chapter will offer replacements to the trigger words.

There are a lot more closing tricks and word tracks, but the bottom line is that closing is 80% set up and 20% close.

EXAMPLES OF NEGATIVE TRIGGERS:

1. **Payments.** Use “**budget**” instead of ‘payments.’ People have been trained to avoid talking about payment.
2. **Credit Check.** Use “**let’s find your best program**” instead of “credit check.”
3. **Bank wants 20% down.** Use “**the suggested investment is 20%.**”
4. **What do you think about this?** Instead use “**how do you feel about this?**” “Think” is a rational word, whereas “feel” speaks to the emotions.
5. **Never call the customer on a lie.** Give them a way out.

EXAMPLE OF NOT CONFRONTING WHITE LIES :

Customer: Another dealer is offering me (this amazing price).

You know the price is well below cost, and it’s a white lie by the customer. Do not say something confrontational like “Why didn’t you buy it?” which is really saying, “I know you are lying.” This **does not** close deals.

Try this instead:

Sales: Ahh. I’m sorry that happened to you. That’s an old low ball trick dealers used to use to send you around the world chasing a fake price, so that in the end you have to come back to them to buy the car. They can’t do it either, but it gives them the last chance to talk to you. They are hoping that you will be exhausted and just buy it from them. We don’t play games with our customers. We value your time. We show you a real and fair deal right up front, and make it easy to do business. If I can have you sign right here, I’ll get this car sent to Detail.

This gives the customer a way to save face and not have to stick to their story.

This image shows a blank sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines, typical of notebook paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are approximately 20 lines visible. The paper has a slightly aged or off-white appearance.

About the Author

Curtis Rigglesman is a successful Director of Operations who currently manages several dealerships in Central California. He came from a background of poverty. Through determination and a winning attitude, he made his way to the top of his field. His passion is to empower new salesmen and sales managers to confidently engage customers and level up their income.



Level Up:

Check out the other books in the series

1. Dial For Dollars

2.Objections Aren't Real

3. The First Five Sales

4. Built To Lead

5. Closing 101



Notes:

[illegible]

CLOSING 101:

There is an art to closing deals. Whether you have a closer, or a sales manager that closes, you will find my real life, time tested techniques for salesmen, and their closers, to close awesome deals.

LEVEL UP:

- Learn the core principles to closing deals while holding gross profit.
- Learn solutions to push through stalls or minor objections.
- Get to yes with your customers, with less wear and tear on everyone involved.



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